# Some art is meant to be touched.

*We walked through teamLab in Tokyo, knee-deep in lit water, and wondered who gets left outside.*



MONA LISA · HER FIGURE · 40 OF 100 BALLS RAISED

### THE VISITOR HEARS

A voice guide tours a famous painting, part by part.

### THE VISITOR FEELS

A 10×10 board of balls raises the shape of the part being described.

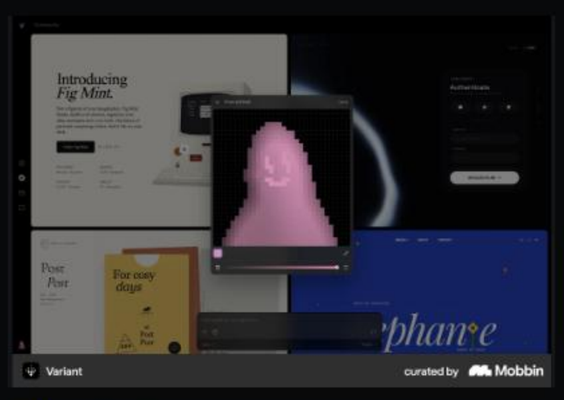
### THE ROOM SEES

This screen: what the visitor hears and feels, live, for everyone watching.

RESEARCH · MOBBIN, 9 SECTIONS

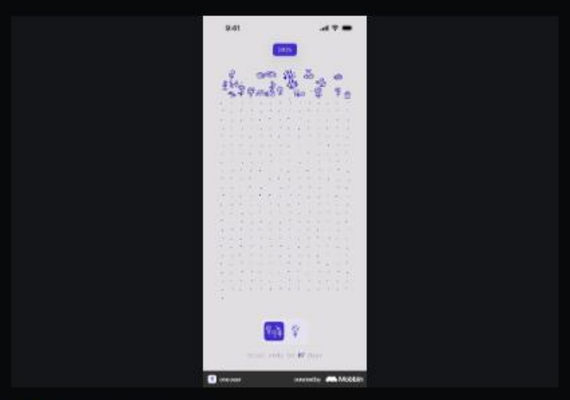
# 147 screens, 24 that shaped it.

*For each one we wrote down what to take and what to leave. These are the ones we took the most from.*



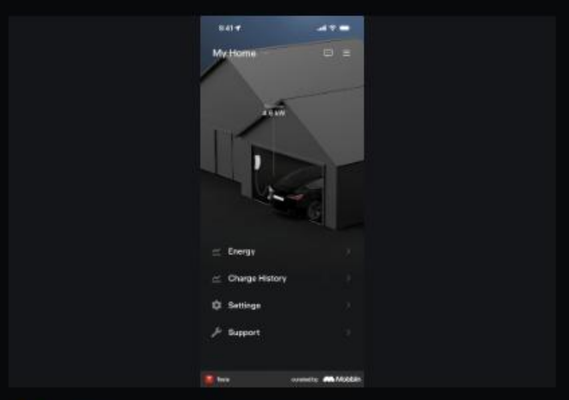

B05 VARIANT

Coarse pixel grids still read as pictures.



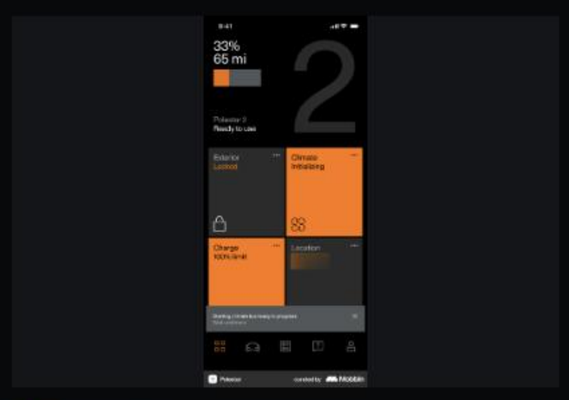
B15 ONE YEAR

A grid of dots with hand-drawn flowers on top.




B19 TESLA

Label the live value on the object itself.



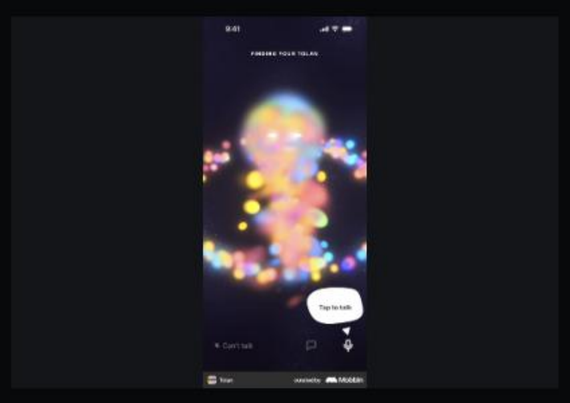

B20 POLESTAR

One huge numeral says where you are.



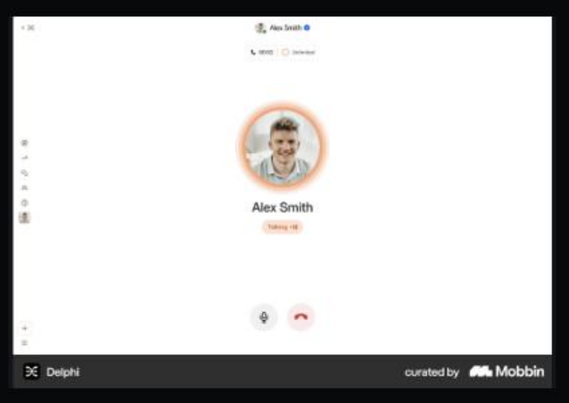

C10 MINDTRIP

Say who is speaking, in words.



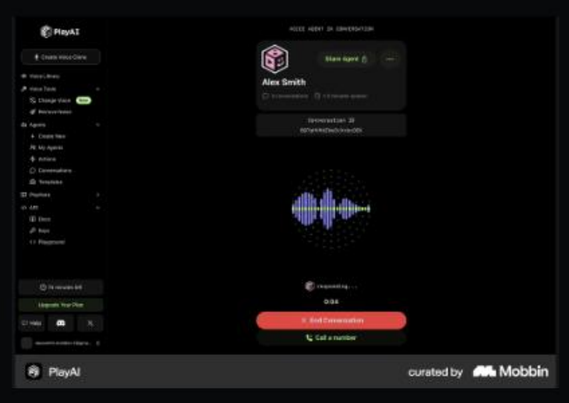

C11 TOLAN

Light on darkness, like a teamLab room.



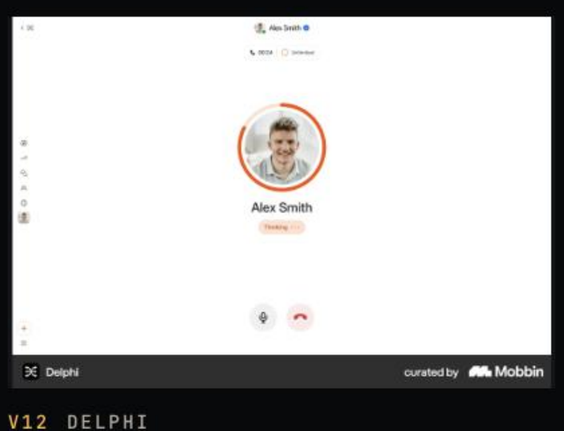

V01 DELPHI

Ripples mean someone is talking.




V03 PLAYAI

A voice waveform drawn out of dots.




V12 DELPHI

A third state between turns: thinking.



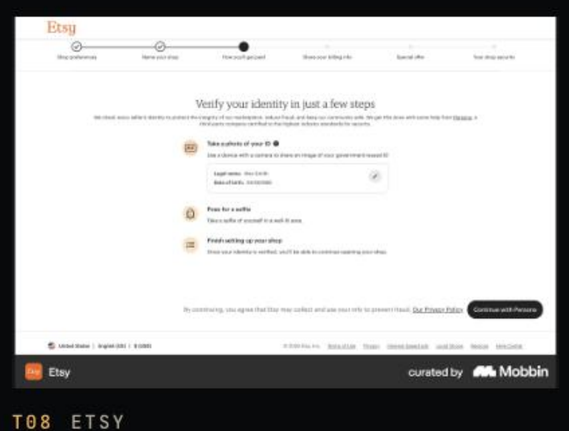

T01 GUSTO

Solid rail for done, dotted for still to come.



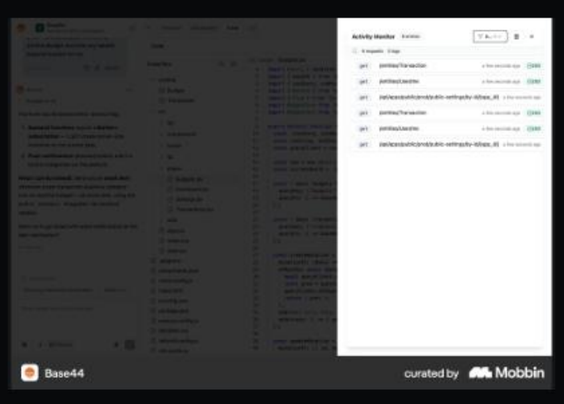

T03 HERS

Serif numerals and hairline rules.



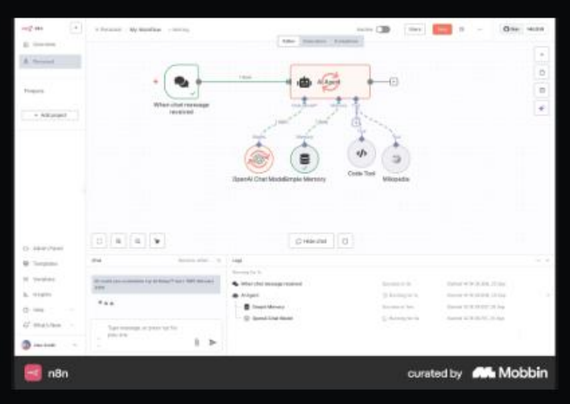

T08 ETSY

Big dot for now, small dots for later.



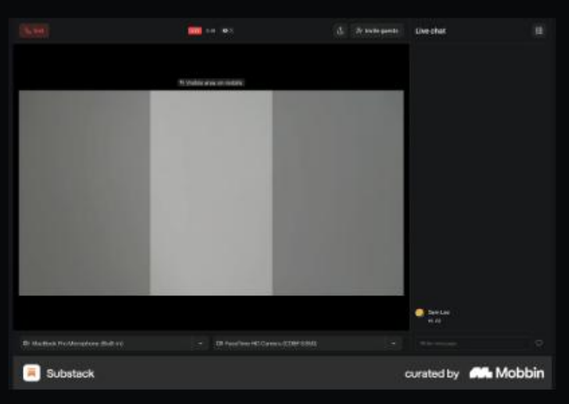

A07 BASE44

A drawer that never reflows the page.



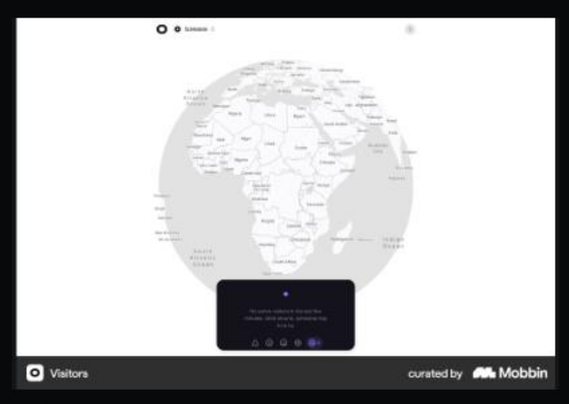

A12 N8N

Show which step of the pipeline is live.




H04 SUBSTACK

A compact LIVE 0:38 tag is enough.



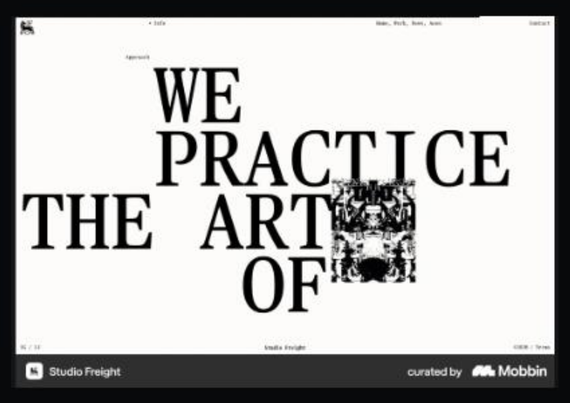

H10 VISITORS

Warm words for an empty room.



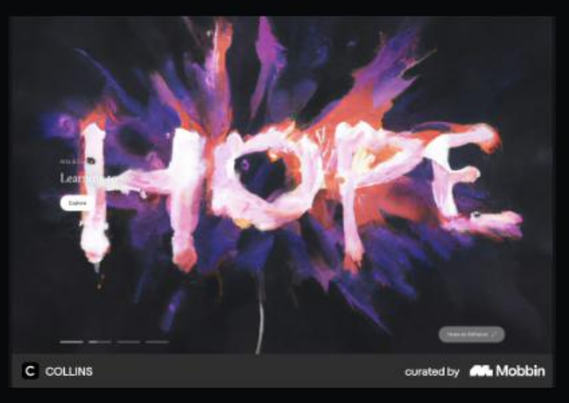

I03 HARVEST

Kicker, title, byline: a wall label.



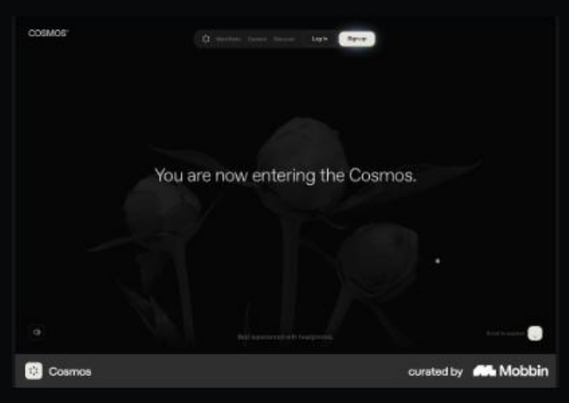

I07 STUDIO FREIGHT

Huge type next to tiny mono labels.



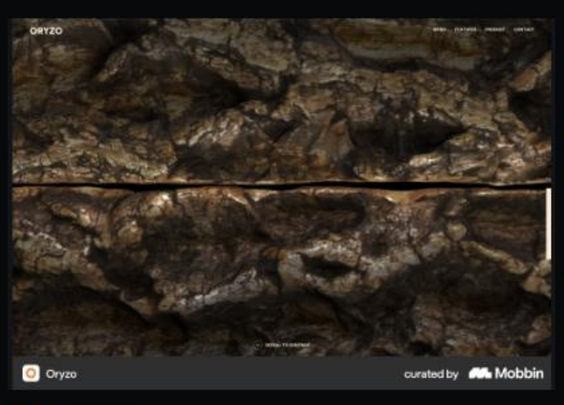

I09 COLLINS

“Learning to see.” The right tone.



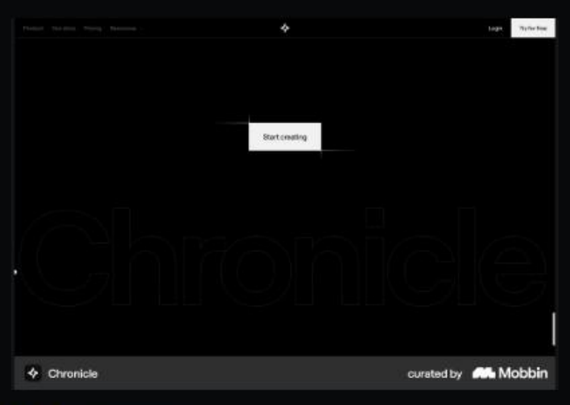

I15 COSMOS

Darkness, faint flowers, one quiet line.




I22 ORYZO

Raking light makes a surface feel touchable.



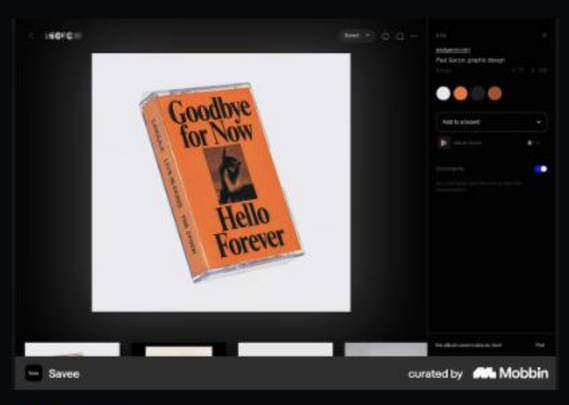

I26 CHRONICLE

A hairline outline as the backdrop.




I28 COSMOS

Tactile objects around a serif headline.




P03 SAVEE

The interface takes the artwork’s colours.

SEVEN PATTERNS KEPT COMING BACK

1 Darkness, with light as the material.

2 Serif display with mono labels: a museum placard.

3 Dots as the shared language, because the board is made of balls.

4 A huge numeral answers “where am I?”

5 Hand-made marks beat the generic look.

6 The interface takes its colour from the art.

7 Avoid blue-purple gradients, glowing orbs, log tables and stacks of cards.

THREE DIRECTIONS

## A · Borderless Night

CHOSEN

One dark gallery room where light is the hierarchy, and the painting flows into the board like teamLab art moving between rooms.

Strongest link to our story. Risk: dark screens wash out on cheap projectors, so text stays at AAA contrast.

## B · Wall Label

Light museum walls, black serif, catalogue numbering. Very legible, less immersive. We kept its type discipline.

## C · Pin Art

The hardware as a 3D hero in raking light. Great for the board, but kitsch risk, and the painting loses the spotlight.

DESIGN SYSTEM · COLOUR

# Lantern Water

*The water room at teamLab Planets, lit by lanterns. Every colour is an object you could point at in that room.*



`--color-ink`

#08090B

*black water · page*



`--color-stone`

#131518

*wet stone · drawer*



`--color-stone-2`

#1C1F23

*stone edge · hairlines, wells*



`--color-paper`

#F2EADC · 16.7:1

*lantern paper · text*



`--color-paper-dim`

#B4AB9C · 8.8:1

*paper in shadow · secondary*



`--color-paper-faint`

#7E776D · 4.5:1

*decoration only*

---



`--color-lantern`

#FFB547 · 11.3:1

*lantern flame · the one accent, it means "now"*



`--color-moss`

#8CC48A · 9.8:1

*moss · DONE*



`--color-koi`

#FF6B4A · 7.1:1

*koi · FAILED*

THREE RULES

One intense colour moment: lantern means now.

Status is never colour alone; it always has a word.

Raised balls take the colour of the painting under them.

DESIGN SYSTEM · TYPE

# A museum wall label

*Instrument Serif speaks, Instrument Sans explains, JetBrains Mono labels. Huge and light next to small and crisp. Nothing below 13px.*

**--text-numeral**
Serif · 360 / 270 px · outline
Part number behind the board

02

**--text-display**
Serif · 80 / 60 px · -0.02em
Painting title, idle headline

Mona Lisa

**--text-title**
Serif · 48 / 36 px
The part being touched

her eyes

**--text-kicker**
Serif italic · 28 / 22 px
Artist, kickers

*Leonardo da Vinci*

**--text-caption-now**
Sans 500 · 30/40 · 24/32 px
The newest spoken line

Her eyes seem to follow you across the room.

**--text-body**
Sans 400 · 20/30 · 17/26 px
Older lines, descriptions

Leonardo painted her without eyebrows, which makes the gaze feel softer.

**--text-label**
Mono 500 · 14 / 13 px · +0.14em
Labels, state words, timers

NOW TOUCHING · 02 / 05

## SPACE · 8PX BASE

spacing-2 · 8

spacing-4 · 16

spacing-5 · 24

spacing-6 · 32

spacing-7 · 48

spacing-8 · 64

spacing-9 · 96 — gutter between art and touch

spacing-10 · 128

Columns 58 / 42. Everything scales with clamp() from 1920 down to 1440, tightens at 720p, and stacks below 1100px.

## SHAPE · CIRCLES AND HAIRLINES




# Circles and hairlines. Light is the only depth.

No cards, no rounded panels, no drop shadows. Every indicator on the screen is the same ball at a different size, so the room speaks the board's language.

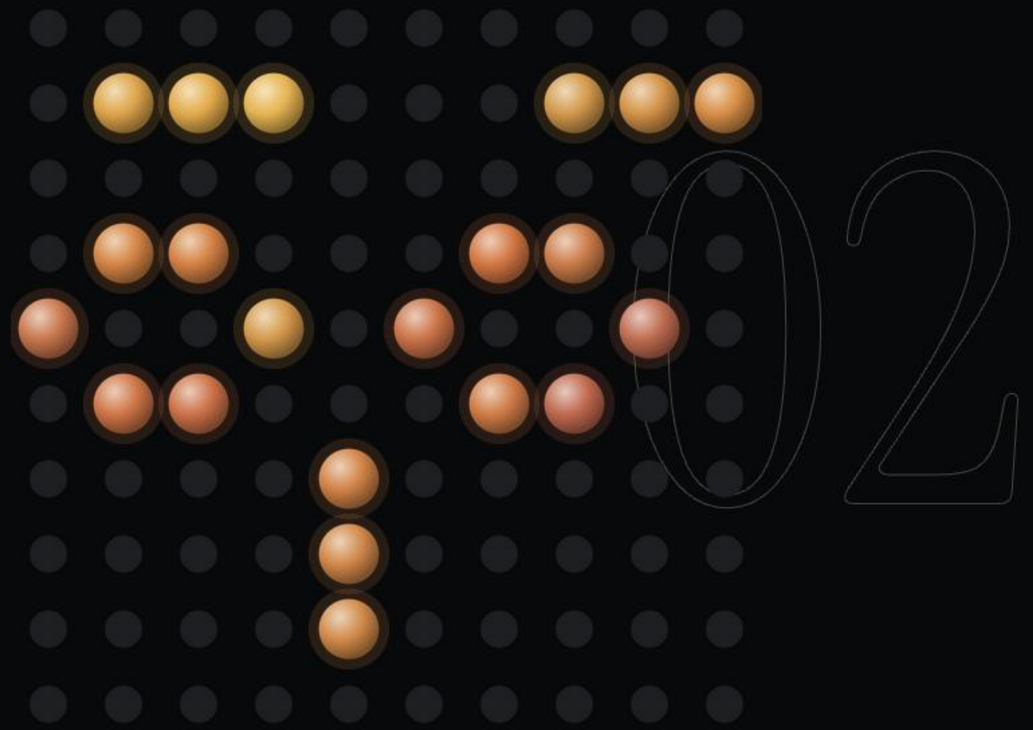
## MOTION · PHYSICAL, NEVER BOUNCY UI

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| --ease-rise | cubic-bezier(.34,1.56,.64,1) | a ball pops up, slight overshoot |
| --ease-light | cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1) | light fades, the spotlight glides |
| --dur-ball + row | 400ms + 70ms per row | rows rise one after another, like the hardware |
| --dur-spot | 600ms | spotlight moves to the next part |
| --dur-flow | 900ms | dots fly from the painting to the board |
| --dur-ripple | 1600ms loop | speaking ripples, like water at your feet |
| reduced motion | 200ms fades | no flying, no ripples, no sweeps |

## VOICE · A MUSEUM PLACARD

| DO | DON'T |
|---|---|
| Now touching: her hands | Section 2 loaded |
| The guide is on a break. | Status: OK |
| Best experienced with your hands. | AI-powered experience |

SIMULATED BOARD




NOW TOUCHING · 02 / 05

# her eyes

TOP CENTER OF THE CANVAS

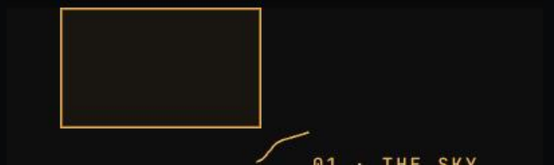
SPOTLIGHT TAG · HANGS OFF THE PART ON A HAND-DRAWN HOOK




ABOVE RIGHT · DEFAULT




ABOVE LEFT · PART AT RIGHT EDGE




BELOW RIGHT · PART AT TOP EDGE




BELOW LEFT · TOP-RIGHT CORNER

Outside the part, the painting dims to 62% ink. The edge is 1.5px lantern. The hook is one wobbly stroke drawn by hand, the only mark on the screen that isn't a circle or a straight line.

TOP STRIP

*Tactile Art Guide*

● LIVE 03:12 [S] AGENTS

SPEAKING INDICATOR · EIGHT DOTS ON A RING



**SPEAKING**
rings ripple outward



**THINKING**
dots orbit while Gemini works



**LISTENING**
a slow breath

CAPTIONS · NEWEST LARGEST, OLDER FADE

VISITOR
Show me the Mona Lisa.

GUIDE
Under your hand is her whole figure, seated, hands folded.

VISITOR
I'm ready for the next part.

GUIDE SPEAKING

**Now her eyes. Leonardo painted them without eyebrows, so the gaze feels soft wherever you stand.**

TOUR RAIL · VISITED, NOW, TO COME

HER FIGURE — HER EYES — HER SMILE — PATH AND BRIDGE — MISTY MOUNTAINS

## Behind the scenes

[S] CLOSE

● DONE — **ElevenLabs**
Voice guide
`In conversation`

● WORKING — **Gemini**
Finds the parts, draws each shape
`Looking up The Birth of Venus`

● WAITING — **Creao**
Tactile Tour Writer agent
–

● FAILED — **Browser Use**
Reads the museum's website
`Museum site timed out`

ON THE WIRE

F0000000000011100111000000000001100110001001010010001100110000001000000000010000000000100000000000000

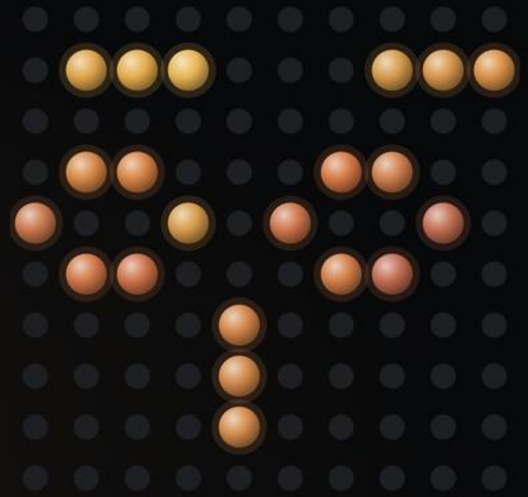



*Leonardo da Vinci*

# Mona Lisa

C. 1503–1506

SIMULATED BOARD



02

NOW TOUCHING · 02 / 05

## her eyes

TOP CENTER OF THE CANVAS

VISITOR SAID

I'm ready for the next part.

GUIDE

That was her figure, the calm pyramid of her body. Tell me when you're ready.

GUIDE SPEAKING

**Now her eyes. Leonardo painted them without eyebrows, so her gaze feels soft wherever you stand.**




*Vincent van Gogh*

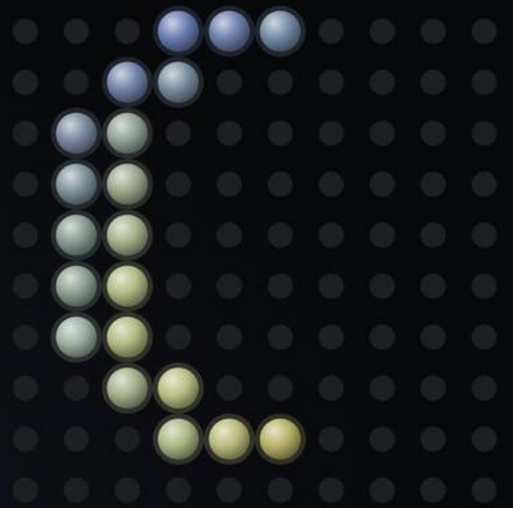
# The Starry Night

1889

THE SWIRLING SKY · THE CRESCENT MOON · THE CYPRESS TREE · THE VILLAGE AND CHURCH



SIMULATED BOARD



02

NOW TOUCHING · 02 / 04

## the crescent moon

TOP RIGHT OF THE CANVAS

VISITOR SAID

What's up in the corner?

GUIDE

That was the swirling sky, wind drawn as rivers of paint. Tell me when you're ready.

GUIDE SPEAKING

**That's the crescent moon. Van Gogh wrapped it in a ring of light, so it glows hotter than any star.**

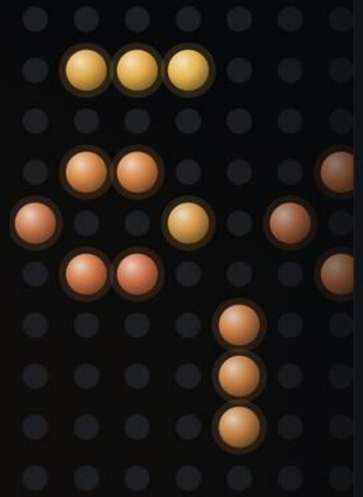



*Leonardo da Vinci*

# Mona Lisa

C. 1503–1506

HER FIGURE · HER EYES · HER ENIGMATIC SMILE · THE WINDING PATH AND BRIDGE



VISITOR SAID

I'm ready for the nex

GUIDE

That was her figure, th
when you're ready.

GUIDE SPEAKING

**Now her eyes.**
**them without**
**feels soft whe**

## Behind the scenes

S CLOSE

- WORKING — **ElevenLabs**
  Voice guide
  show_section("next") → her eyes
- DONE — **Gemini**
  Finds the parts, draws each shape
  5 parts found · 5 shapes drawn
- WORKING — **Creao**
  Tactile Tour Writer agent
  Writing guide notes for her eyes
- DONE — **Browser Use**
  Reads the museum's website
  3 facts from louvre.fr

ON THE WIRE

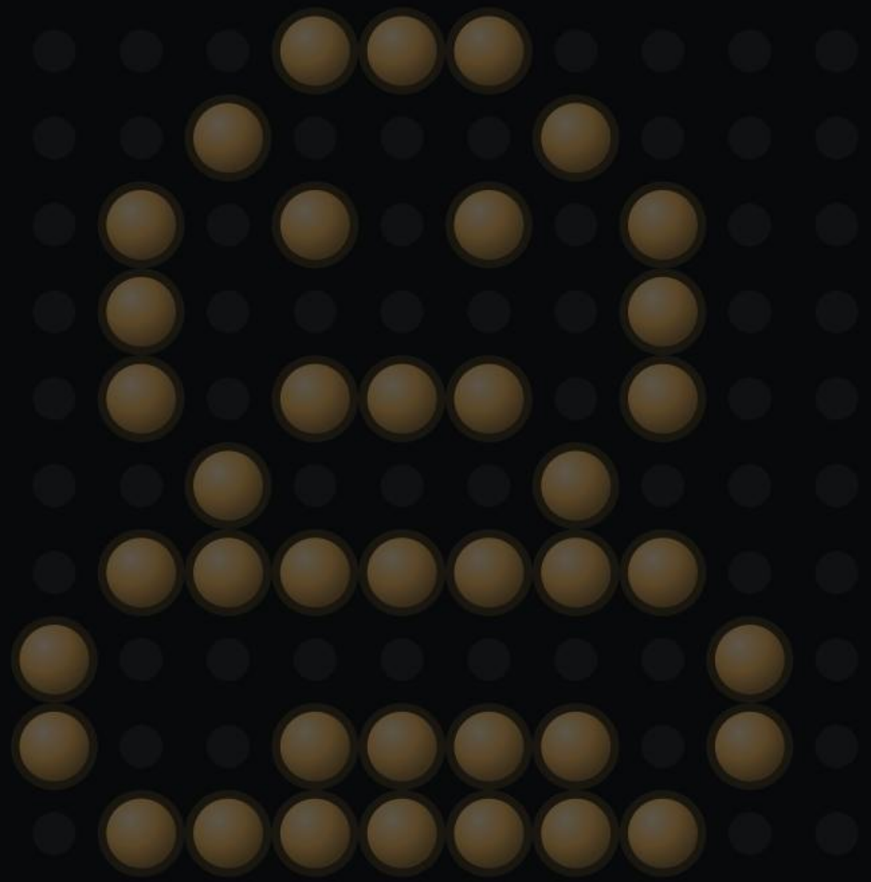
F0000000000011100011100000000000110001100100101001001100011000000100000000010000000001000000000000000



*Mona Lisa · her figure*

# Some art is meant to be touched.

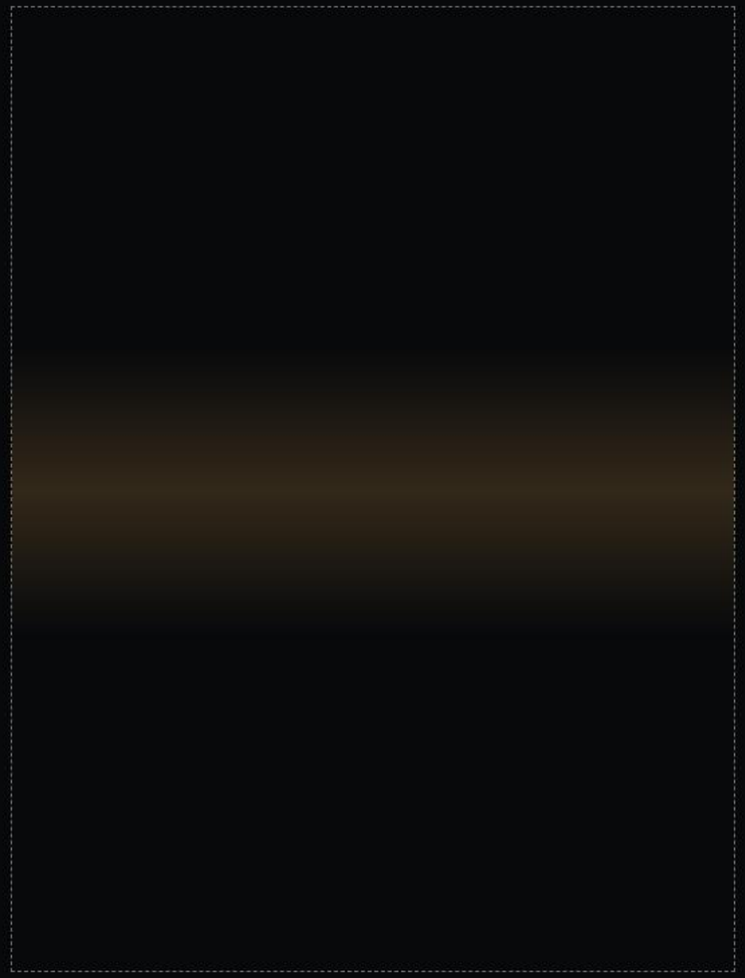
SAY “SHOW ME THE MONA LISA”



*The gallery is closed*

# The guide is on a break.

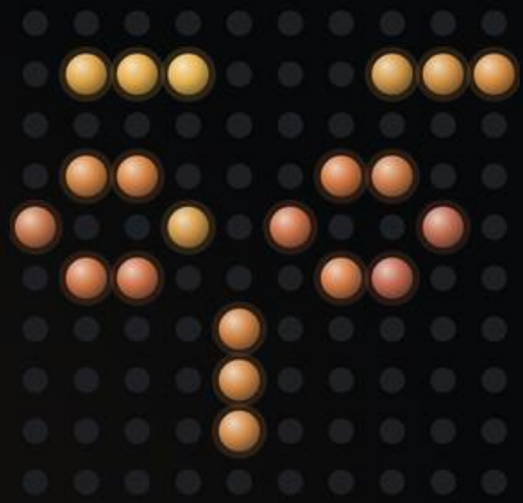
START MAIN.PY TO OPEN THE GALLERY.



FINDING THE PARTS OF THE PAINTING

# Looking up The Birth of Venus

SIMULATED BOARD



02




NOW TOUCHING · 02 / 05

## her eyes

TOP CENTER OF THE CANVAS

VISITOR SAID

I'm ready for the next part.

GUIDE

That was her figure, the calm pyramid of her body. Tell me when you're ready.

GUIDE SPEAKING

**Now her eyes. Leonardo painted them without eyebrows, so her gaze feels soft wherever you stand.**

*Leonardo da Vinci*

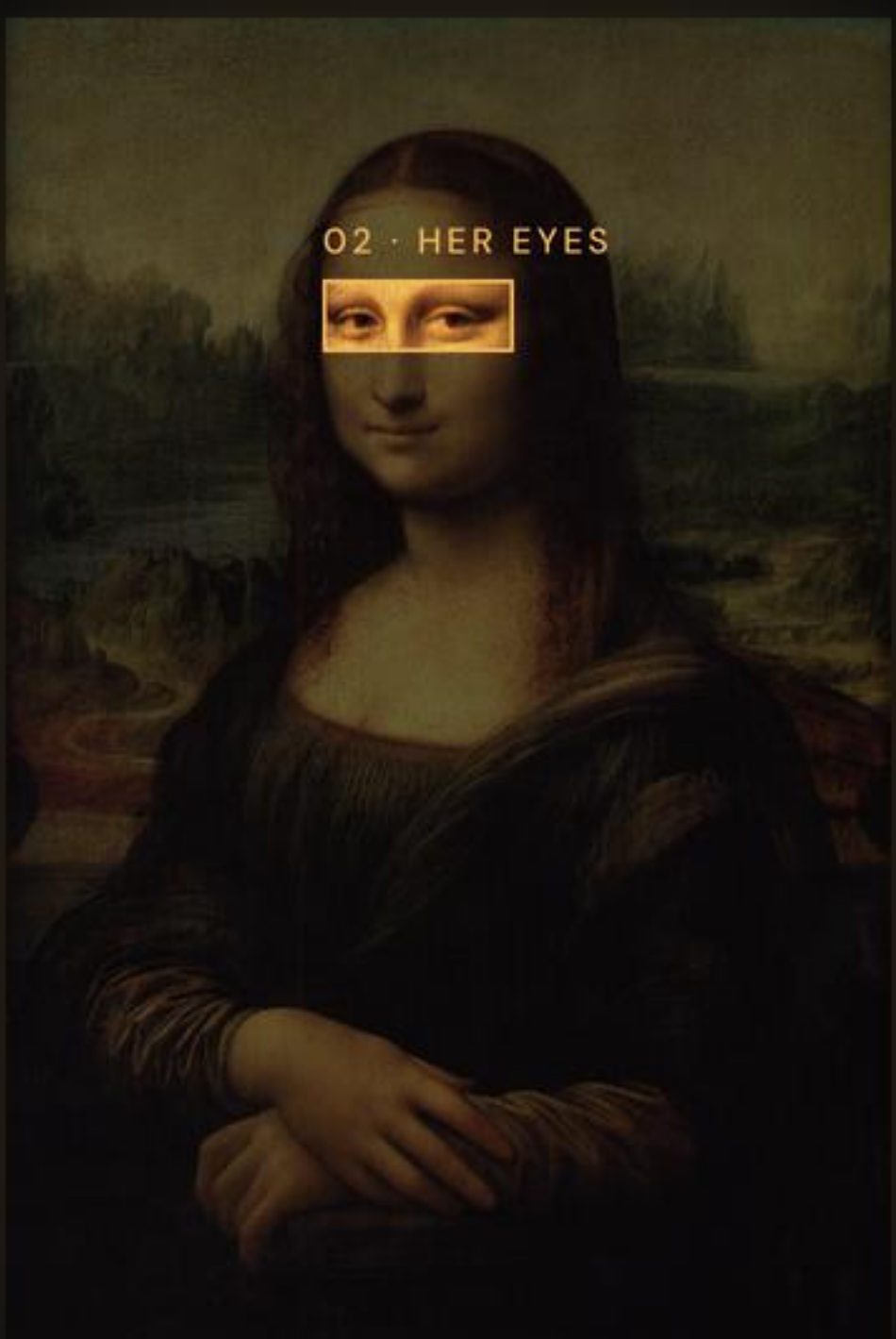
# Mona Lisa

C. 1503–1506

HER FIGURE · HER EYES · HER ENIGMATIC SMILE · THE WINDING PATH AND BRIDGE · THE MISTY MOUNTAINS

# Tactile Art Guide

● LIVE 03:12 [S] AGENTS

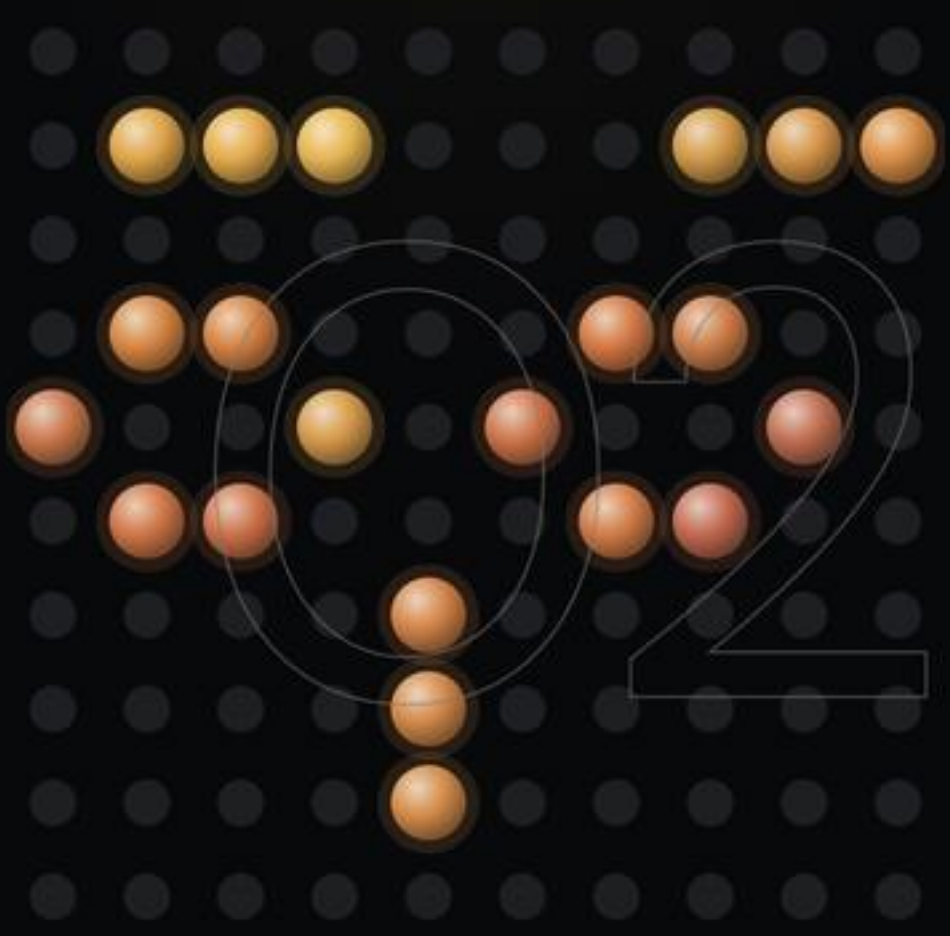



*Leonardo da Vinci*

# Mona Lisa

C. 1503–1506

SIMULATED BOARD




NOW TOUCHING · 02 / 05

## her eyes

TOP CENTER OF THE CANVAS

VISITOR SAID

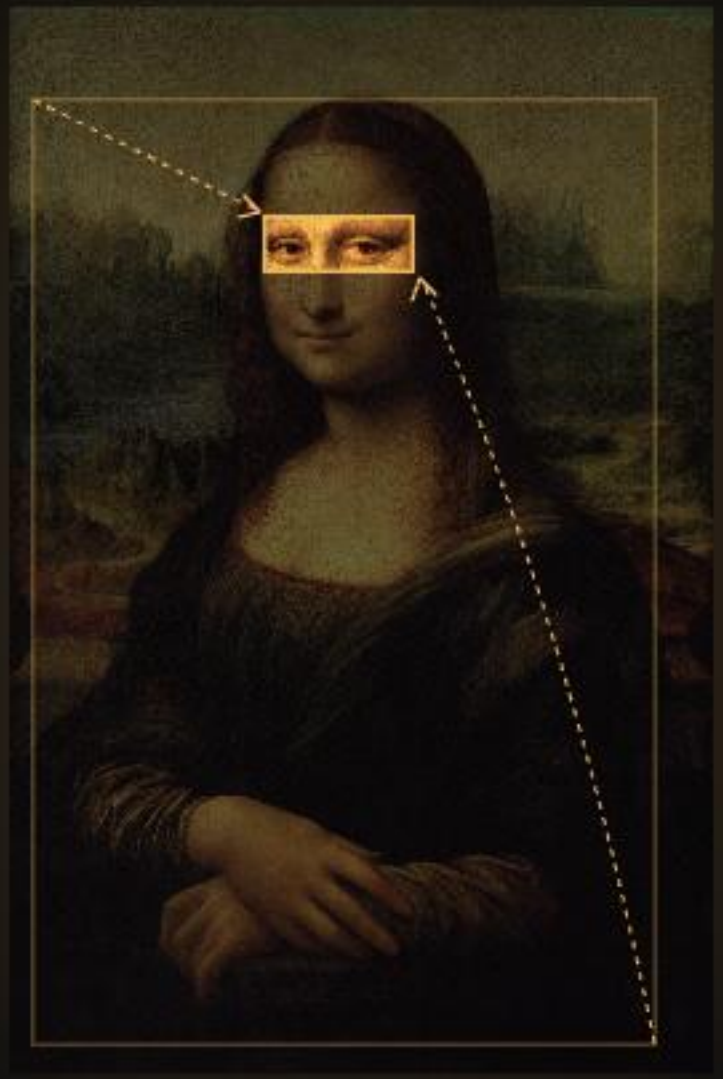
I'm ready for the next part.

GUIDE SPEAKING

**Now her eyes. Leonardo painted them without eyebrows, so her gaze feels soft wherever you stand.**

- HER FIGURE
- HER EYES
- HER ENIGMATIC SMILE
- THE WINDING PATH AND BRIDGE
- THE MISTY MOUNTAINS

01 # Spotlight glides

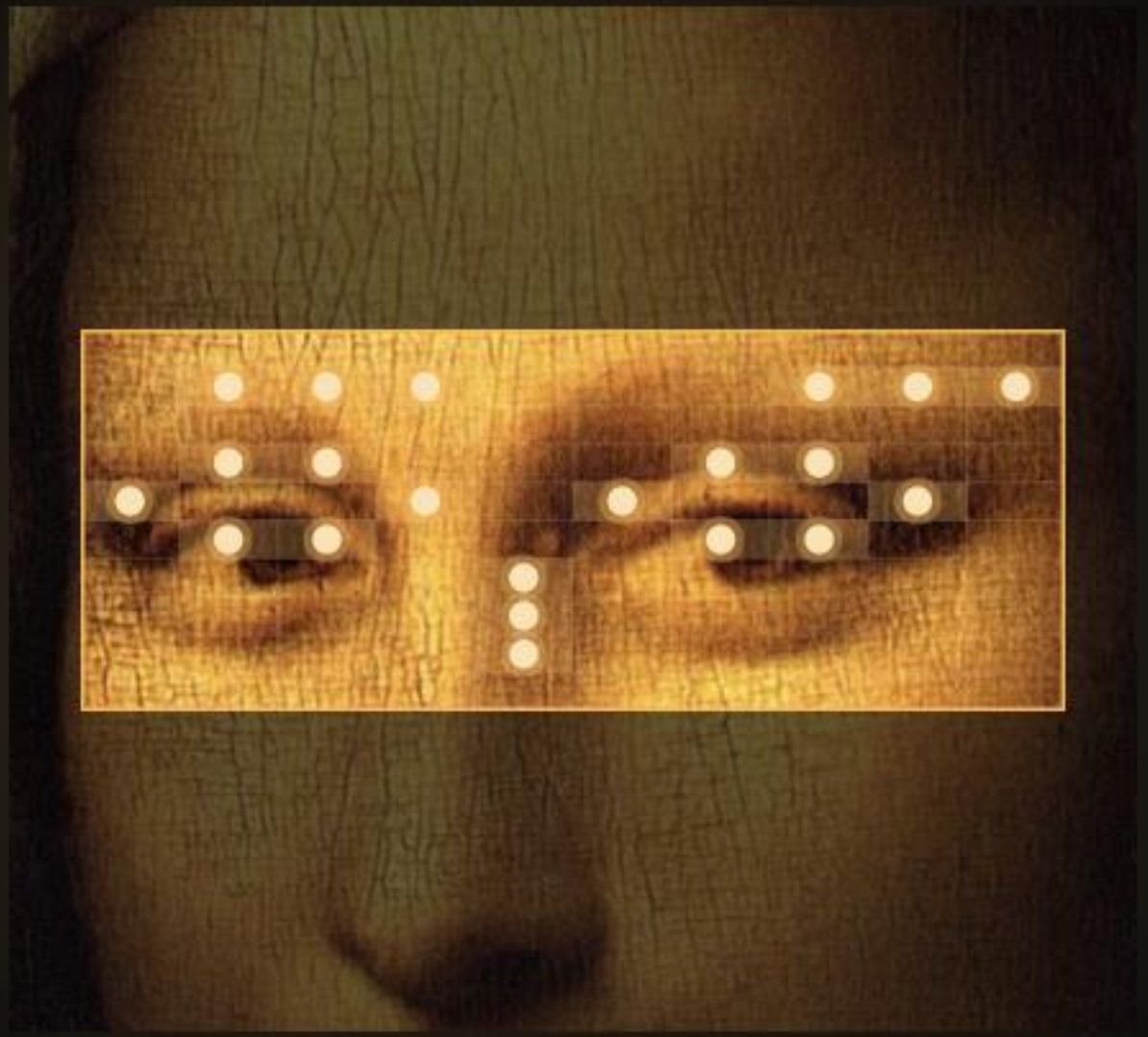


0–600 MS

The spotlight shrinks from her figure to her eyes. The old box fades out; the board waits, all balls down.

02

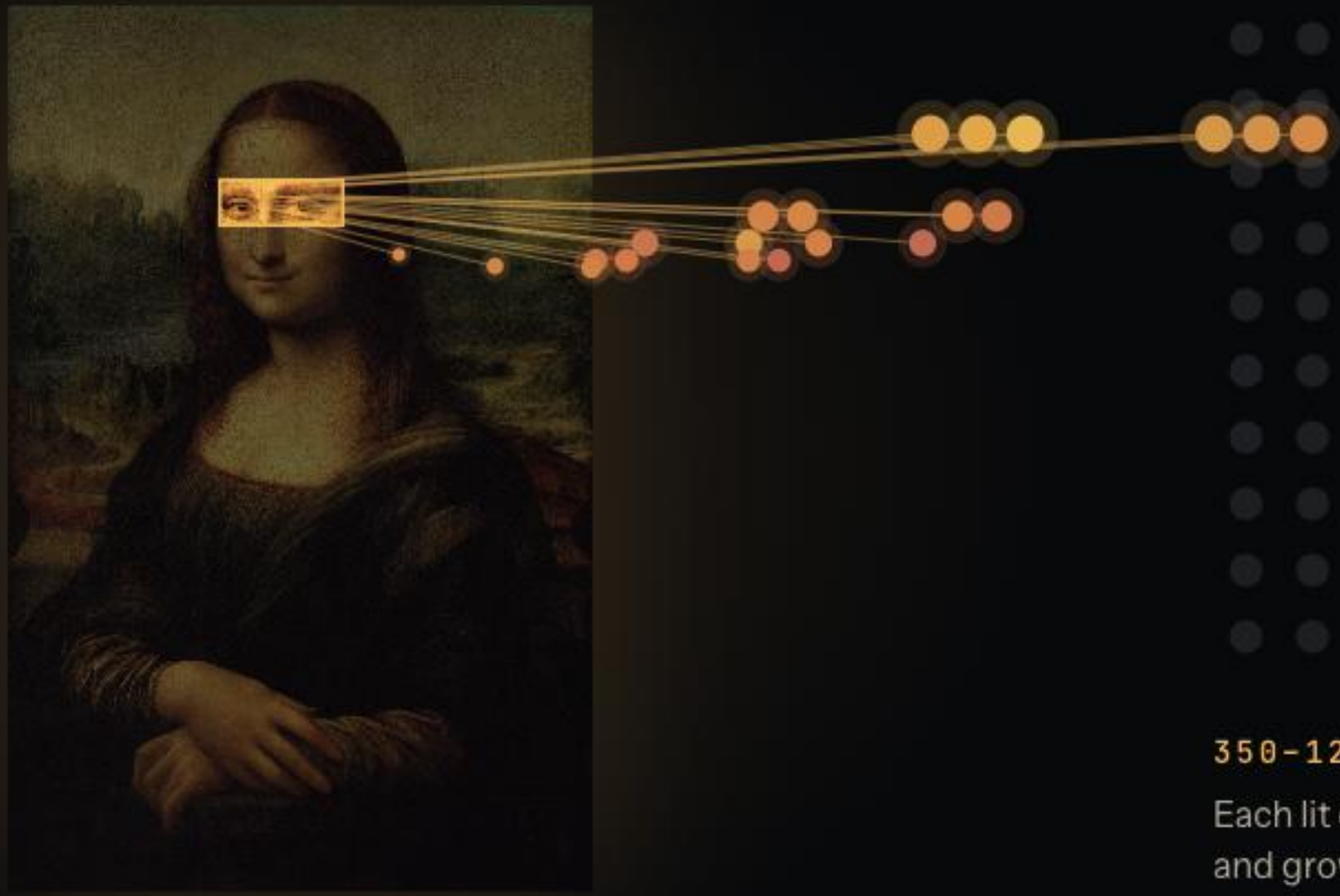
# The part lights up



0–350 MS

A faint 10×10 grid lands on the box, and the cells the board will raise glow lantern. Detail view, enlarged.

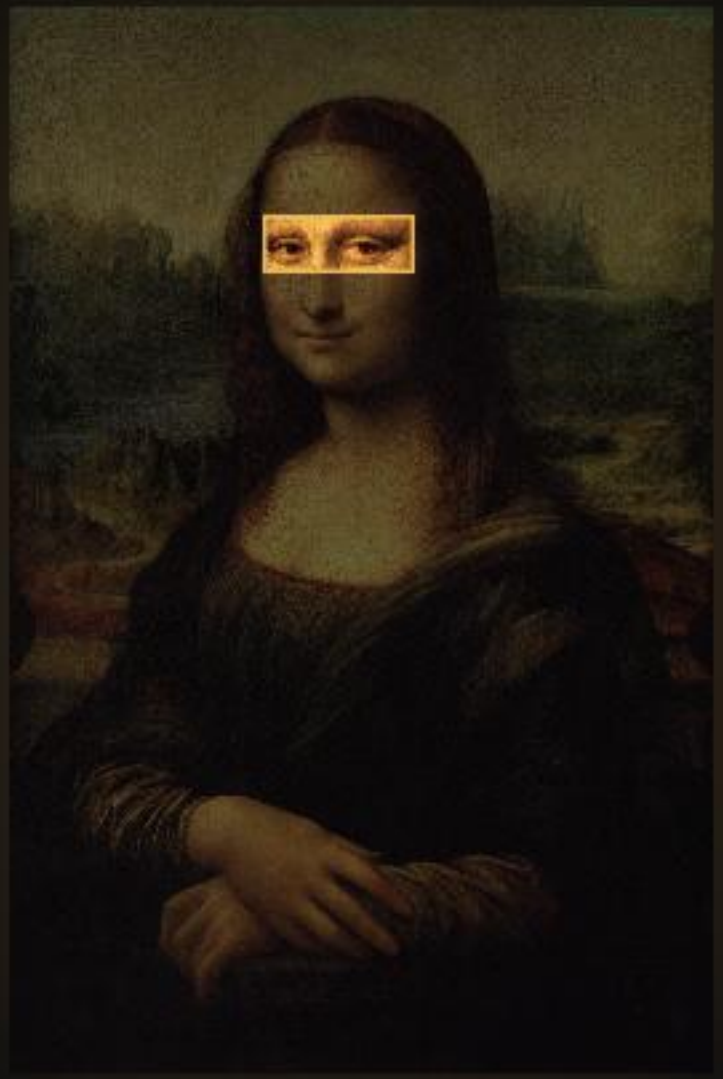
03 Dots fly

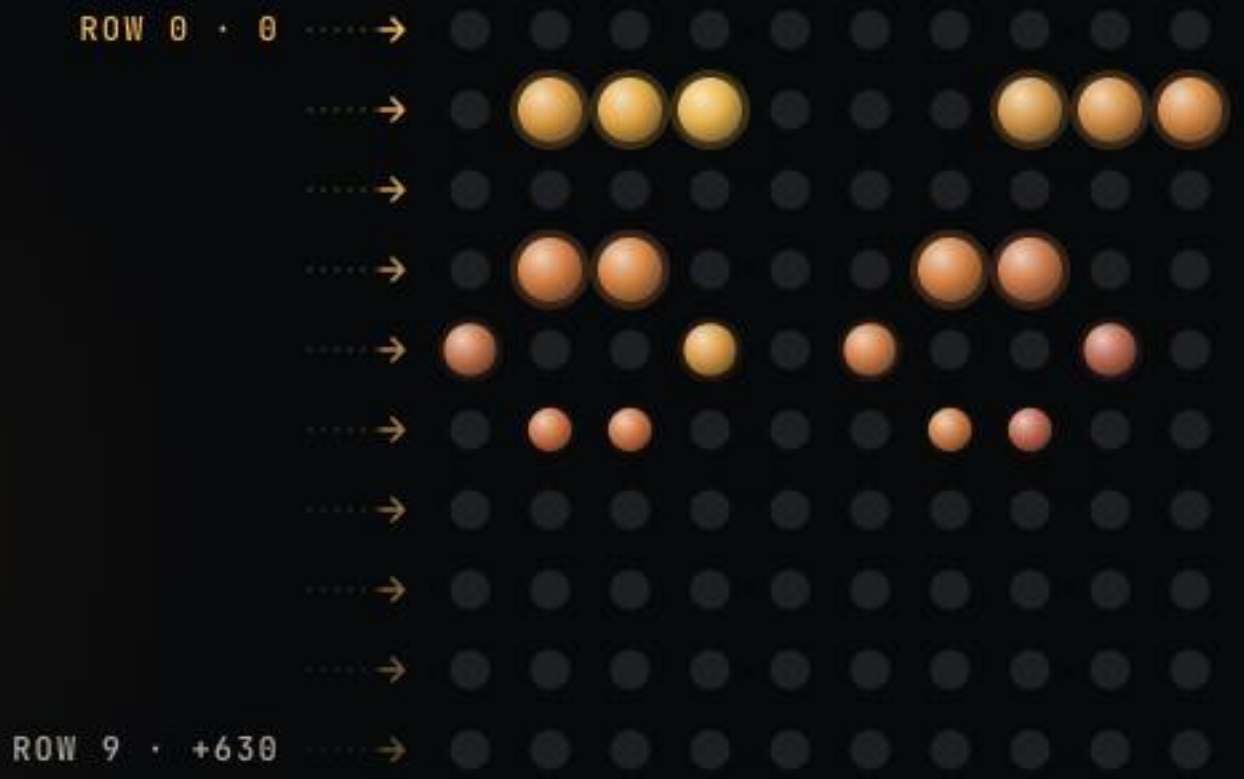


350–1250 MS

Each lit cell lifts off in the painting's colour and grows as it crosses the room to its well on the board.

# 04 Balls rise






**+70 MS PER ROW**

The balls rise in the painting's colours, top row first, so the shape draws itself from the far edge toward your hands.